ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR — MASTER REVIEW SHEET

Comprehensive Open-Book Exam Companion: Sessions 1–15 Core Theories, Diagnostic Frameworks & Case Syntheses

EXAM DIAGNOSTIC STRATEGY

Open-Book Exam Rule of Thumb: Do not spend time defining terms from scratch. Map case facts directly to framework components (e.g., *P-J vs P-G fit*, *Lojeski's Virtual Distance*, *Pfeffer's Power Tactics*, *Katzenbach's Real Team Criteria*, *Brett's 4 Cultural Barriers*). Always state: (1) Diagnosed OB Problem, (2) Grounding Framework & Specific Dimension, (3) Case Evidence, and (4) Actionable Managerial/Structural Intervention.

PART I: INDIVIDUAL DIFFERENCES & INTERPERSONAL DYNAMICS (SESSIONS 1–5)

Session 1: Personality, Individual Differences & Strengths

• **Big Five Model (NEO-PI):** Grounded in trait stability across contexts. *Conscientiousness* (reliability, goal-striving, orderliness — highest predictor of job performance); *Extraversion* (sociability, assertiveness, dominance — predicts leadership emergence & sales); *Emotional Stability / Neuroticism* (calmness under stress vs hypervigilance & anxiety); *Agreeableness* (cooperativeness, trust, compliance — predicts teamwork & customer service, but lower earnings); *Openness to Experience* (creativity, curiosity, adaptability to change).
• **MBTI vs Big Five:** MBTI forces binary types (E/I, S/N, T/F, J/P), lacks predictive validity for job performance, and suffers from low test-retest reliability. MBTI is useful only for team self-awareness, not selection.
• **The Dark Triad:** *Machiavellianism* (pragmatic, ends justify means, emotional distance, manipulation); *Narcissism* (entitlement, grandiosity, self-absorption); *Psychopathy* (lack of remorse/empathy, impulsivity).
• **Approach-Avoidance Motivation:** High approach individuals are energized by competition and rewards; high avoidance individuals are distracted and demotivated by fear of failure.
• **Core Self-Evaluation (CSE):** Bottom-line self-assessment of capability and worth. High CSE set ambitious goals and persist; low CSE feel powerless and self-doubting.
• **Self-Monitoring:** High self-monitors adjust behavior to external situational cues; low self-monitors exhibit high consistency across situations regardless of context.
• **Situation Strength & Trait Activation Theory (TAT):** *Situation Strength* (Clarity, Consistency, Constraints, Consequences) suppresses personality traits in strong situations. *TAT* predicts that specific job cues (e.g., tight deadlines for a broadcast analyst) activate latent traits (Conscientiousness/Neuroticism).
• **Reflected Best Self (RBS) & POS:** Positive Organisational Scholarship focuses on strengths-based role design rather than weakness fixation.

Session 2: Interpersonal Relationships, Fit & Interpersonal Trust

• **EVLN Model (Responses to Job Dissatisfaction):** *Exit* (Active/Destructive — quitting, transferring); *Voice* (Active/Constructive — suggesting improvements, seeking feedback); *Loyalty* (Passive/Constructive — waiting optimistically for conditions to improve); *Neglect* (Passive/Destructive — absenteeism, bare minimum effort, tardiness).
• **4-Level Workplace Fit Framework:**
1. *Person-Job (P-J) Fit:* Alignment of skills/abilities with task demands (Job satisfaction r=0.56, Performance r=0.20).
2. *Person-Organization (P-O) Fit:* Congruence between personal values and corporate culture (Job satisfaction r=0.44, Intent to quit r=-0.35).
3. *Person-Group (P-G) Fit:* Interpersonal compatibility with immediate teammates (Job satisfaction r=0.31).
4. *Person-Supervisor (P-S) Fit:* Dyadic rapport and trust with manager (Job satisfaction r=0.44).

• **Katz's Managerial Skills Hierarchy:** Entry-level managers require high *Technical skills* and lower *Strategic/Conceptual skills*; Top-level executives require high *Strategic/Conceptual skills* and lower *Technical skills*. *Human/Interpersonal skills* are equally vital across all levels.
• **Abrams et al. Interpersonal Trust:** Built on *Benevolence* (caring about others' welfare), *Competence* (believing in technical capability), and *Integrity* (consistency between words and actions).

Session 3: Social Networks & Relational Fitness

• **Network Metrics & Topology:** *Degree Centrality* (number of direct ties); *Betweenness Centrality / Brokerage* (connecting unconnected groups, bridging structural holes); *Structural Holes* (gaps between distinct network clusters that offer non-redundant information and power).
• **Networking Principles:** *Proximity Principle* (ties formed due to physical closeness, e.g., adjacent seating); *Self-Similarity Principle / Homophily* (forming ties with people who share similar backgrounds/ideas); *Shared Activity Principle* (building diverse networks around passionate, unscripted cross-functional activities).
• **Echo Chambers:** Homogeneous networks where redundant information is constantly reinforced, stifling innovation and creating blind spots.
• **Ibarra & Hunter's 3 Networks:** *Operational* (internal day-to-day execution); *Personal* (discretionary professional development & support); *Strategic* (future-oriented, connecting opinion leaders inside/outside the firm to drive strategic change).

Session 4: Communication, Psychological Safety & Voice

• **Employee Voice vs Silence (Morrison):** Inhibitors of voice are *Fear* (perceived career/image risk) and *Futility* (belief that speaking up won't change anything).
• **Virtuous Speak-Up Cycle vs Vicious Silence Cycle:** Speak-up cycle builds trust and early warning signals; silence cycle leads to hidden risks and organizational failure.
• **Edmondson's Psychological Safety:** A shared belief that the team is safe for interpersonal risk-taking (asking questions, admitting mistakes, offering ideas).
• **Edmondson's 4-Zone Matrix (Accountability vs Safety):**
- Low Safety / Low Accountability = *Apathy Zone*
- High Safety / Low Accountability = *Comfort Zone*
- Low Safety / High Accountability = *Anxiety Zone* (Dangerous — errors are hidden)
- High Safety / High Accountability = *Learning & High Performance Zone*
• **Learning Modes:** *Single-Loop Learning* (fixing symptoms without questioning underlying rules); *Double-Loop Learning* (questioning underlying assumptions, policies, and values).
• **Detert's Competent Courage Framework:** 4-step action for voice: (1) Lay groundwork, (2) Select the battle, (3) Frame the message, (4) Manage follow-up.
• **Case: Air India Express (AXB 1344 Crash):** Catastrophic gap between pilot voice and formal agency under low psychological safety.

Session 5: Negotiation Strategy & Value Creation

• **Negotiation Elements:** *Issue* (topic negotiated); *Position* (stated demand); *Interest* (underlying need/motivation).
• **Dual Concern Model:** Maps Concern for Self vs Concern for Others across *Avoidance* (Low/Low), *Accommodation* (Low Self/High Other), *Competition* (High Self/Low Other), and *Collaboration* (High/High).
• **Distributive vs Integrative Bargaining:** *Distributive* (fixed pie, zero-sum, position-focused); *Integrative* (expanding the pie, win-win, interest-focused).
• **Pareto Efficient Frontier:** The boundary where no party can be made better off without making the other worse off.
• **Integrative Tactics (Lewicki et al.):** *Logrolling* (trading off high-priority vs low-priority issues across parties); *Bridging & Superordination* (inventing new options meeting core interests); *Nonspecific Compensation*; maintaining *Firm Flexibility* (firm on interests, flexible on means).

PART II: POWER, POLITICS & CONFLICT (SESSIONS 6–8)

Session 6: Power, Politics & Conflict Antecedents

• **Definition of Power:** The potential ability to influence the behavior of others.
• **4 Antecedents of Conflict:** (1) *Goal Incompatibility*, (2) *Differentiation* (varying values/styles), (3) *Task Interdependence*, and (4) *Limited Resources*.
• **Bases of Power:**
- *Positional Power:* Legitimate (formal rank), Reward (resource control), Coercive (punishment/sanctions).
- *Personal Power:* Expert (specialized knowledge), Referent (respect, charisma, identification).
- *Relational / Information Power:* Network centrality and control over critical information flows.
• **Pfeffer's Power Play (Bare-Knuckle Political Tactics):**
- *Barriers to Power:* Just-World Hypothesis (believing merit alone is rewarded), Flawed Leadership Literature (over-emphasizing modesty/purity), Self-Handicapping.
- *Core Tactics:* Mete out discretionary resources; shape behavior via rewards/punishments; make the first move; co-opt antagonists (granting critics budget/roles to redirect their energy); remove rivals nicely ('strategic outplacement'); frame personal visions as compelling public goods.
• **Case: Strike in Space (Skylab 3):** Astronauts Carr, Gibson, and Pogue executed a 1-day work stoppage on Dec 27, 1973. Mission Control's extreme micro-management (42 teleprinter tasks/day), benchmark bias (using Skylab 2 peak performance as a baseline for rookies), and public reprimand by Alan Shepard over Pogue's motion sickness destroyed psychological safety, causing a shift from Voice/Loyalty to Strike/Exit.

Session 7: Levers of Influence, Status & Leadership Dynamics

• **Influence Tactics:** 11 core levers divided by outcome:
- *Commitment & Trust Tactics:* Rationality, Consultation, Collaboration, Apprising, Inspirational Appeals.
- *Compliance / Friction Tactics:* Pressure, Legitimating, Coalitions, Ingratiation, Exchange, Personal Appeals.
• **Status Mechanics:** *Push Status* (asserting dominance, competing, criticizing — elevates self at others' expense, creating friction); *Pull Status* (elevating others via inclusion, active listening, complimenting — builds relational capital).
• **Case: Paul McGinley (Ryder Cup 2014):** Masterclass in managing individualist Type A1 golfers without forcing generic cohesion.
- *Data Analytics:* Hired `strokeaverage.com` to analyze 10 years of Gleneagles course data; proved par-5 scoring drove success and created scientific alternate-shot pairings (big hitters on even holes, shorter hitters on odd holes).
- *Stealth Management:* Secretly pre-arranged European Tour draws months prior so pairs bonded organically.
- *Support Subsystems & Hierarchy:* Empowered caddies (identical gear/accommodations, strategic briefing authority); established a 3-line communication model; appointed a 5th vice-captain dedicated strictly to benched players.
- *Heart-Level Framing:* Used superordinate & sub-national identity, Canadian Geese V-formation metaphor, and 'Rock in the Ocean' graphic.

Session 8: Difficult Conversations & Disagreement Management

• **The Three Conversations Architecture (Stone & Hering):**
1. *The 'What Happened?' Conversation:* Shift from arguing truth/error to exploring differing data; shift from assigning *blame* to mapping joint *contribution*; disentangle *intention from impact* (defensiveness occurs when impact is misread as malicious intent).
2. *The Feelings Conversation:* Unaddressed emotions drive arguments; acknowledge feelings as core data without assigning blame.
3. *The Identity Conversation:* Manage internal dialogue regarding self-worth ('Am I competent/good?') to prevent defensiveness under critical feedback.
• **Receptiveness & Disagreement Tools:**
- *The Listening Triangle:* Ask a question $\rightarrow$ Listen $\rightarrow$ Acknowledge and reflect.
- *The HEAR Framework (Minson):* **H**edge claims ('I think it's possible'), **E**mphasize agreement, **A**cknowledge other perspectives, **R**eframe to positive.
- *Managing Team Disagreements (Brett & Goldberg):* Start with separate meetings to build empathy before joint sessions; avoid traps of arguing over *Facts* (agree to disagree), *Rights* (refocus on information), and *Power* (highlight cost of non-settlement).

PART III: TEAM DYNAMICS, DIVERSITY & GLOBAL WORK (SESSIONS 9–11)

Session 9: Team Chemistry, Roles & Diversity

• **Belbin's 9 Team Roles Matrix:**
- *Action Roles:* **Shaper** (drives momentum; disallowable weakness: provocativeness/clashing), **Implementer** (practical execution), **Completer-Finisher** (perfectionist detail).
- *People Roles:* **Coordinator** (delegates & clarifies goals), **Team Worker** (diplomatic conciliator), **Resource Investigator** (external networking).
- *Thinking Roles:* **Plant** (creative visionary; allowable weakness: ignoring practical details), **Monitor Evaluator** (sober analyst), **Specialist** (domain expert).
• **Deloitte's Team Chemistry Framework:** Classifies styles into *Pioneers* (spark energy/possibility), *Drivers* (momentum/logic), *Guardians* (stability/data/rigor), and *Integrators* (relationships/consensus). Leaders must prevent *Cognitive Cascades* (dominant styles overpowering quiet Guardians/Integrators) by giving prep time and elevating minority voices.

Session 10: Multicultural Teams, Faultlines & Team Life Cycle

• **Team Life Cycle Models:**
- *Tuckman's Model:* Forming $\rightarrow$ Storming $\rightarrow$ Norming $\rightarrow$ Performing $\rightarrow$ Adjourning.
- *Gersick's Punctuated Equilibrium Model:* Teams experience long periods of inertia punctuated by a 'midpoint revolution' where group norms are radically restructured.
• **Managing Multicultural Teams (Brett, Behfar & Kern):**
- *4 Cultural Barriers:* Direct vs Indirect communication; Accents & fluency; Differing attitudes toward hierarchy; Conflicting decision-making norms.
- *4 Intervention Strategies:* **Adaptation** (team solves own friction); **Structural Intervention** (subdividing tasks / reorganizing subgroups); **Managerial Intervention** (setting top-down ground rules); **Exit**.
• **Case: Henry Tam and the MGI Team:** A 7-member startup team experienced severe deadlock 3 weeks before deadline. Deep subgroup **faultlines** separated HBS MBAs (Henry, Dana) and Russian founders/musicians (Sasha, Igor, Roman) along cultural, functional, and target-market lines (Education vs Entertainment). Role ambiguity led Sasha to view MBAs as 'interns'. Henry and Dana used a *Structural Intervention* (a pre-planned 'good cop / bad cop' routine and research stacks) to force compromise proposals.

Session 11: Virtual Teams, Hybrid Work & Global Leadership

• **Virtual Distance Model (Lojeski & Reilly):** Measures psychological gap across 3 dimensions:
- *Physical Distance:* Geographic and temporal separation.
- *Operational Distance:* Variations in team size, member commitments, and technical support.
- *Affinity Distance:* Cultural gaps, rank differences, lack of trust and interdependence.
Impact of High Virtual Distance: Drops in Trust (-83%), Innovation (-93%), Satisfaction (-80%), and Performance (-50%).
• **Virtual Best Practices (Ferrazzi / Haas):** Establish *X-Teams* (Core, Operational, Outer); focus on critical touchpoints (*Kickoff, Onboarding, Milestones*); eliminate *Proximity Bias* in hybrid work.
• **Case: Sun Microsystems (Greg James):** A 45-person team across Santa Clara, Mumbai, Dubai, and Paris suffered an escalation failure during an outage at HS Holdings bank. Root causes: (1) Fixed 08:00 PST calls forcing 15-hour days in India, (2) Proximity bias / informal 'water-cooler' decision-making in Santa Clara, (3) Compensation and vacation friction in France, (4) Queue bugs & regional reporting friction between UAE and India, and (5) Collapse of psychological safety after Nick Elliott disparaged Indian competence.

PART IV: TOP MANAGEMENT TEAMS, SYNERGY & CRISIS (SESSIONS 12–15)

Sessions 12–13: Team Processes, Decision-Making & Synergy

• **Fundamental Performance Equation:** $\text{Actual Productivity} = \text{Potential Productivity} + \text{Synergy} - \text{Process Losses}$.
• **Process Losses & Mitigations:**
- *Common Knowledge Effect / Groupthink:* Teams over-discuss shared information while ignoring unshared unique expertise.

Mitigate via pre-discussion charters, nominal group technique, and assigning devil's advocates.
- *Conflict Types:* Distinguish between *Task Conflict* (creative abrasion — healthy) and *Relationship Conflict* (personal abrasion — destructive).
• **Rethinking Teams (Mortensen & Haas):** Modern team boundaries are shifting from fixed membership to dynamic participation across *Fluidity* (shifting members), *Overlap* (concurrent multi-teaming), and *Dispersion*.

Session 14: Business Case for Commitment to Diversity

• **Diversity as a Strategic Asset:** Drives competitive advantage through broader market reach, higher decision comprehensiveness, and strategic innovation (bringing diverse voices into strategy dialogue per Gary Hamel).
• **Performance Linkage:** Top 50 Diversity companies achieve superior financial metrics (net profit margin, ROA) when supported by an inclusive organizational climate.

Session 15: Top Management Teams & Crisis Leadership

• **Katzenbach's 'Myth of the Top Management Team':**
- *Working Group vs Real Team:* Senior executive groups seldom function as 'Real Teams' — they usually operate as 'Working Groups' with individual functional accountabilities.
- *'All My Direct Reports' Fallacy:* Assuming direct reports automatically form a team is a mistake. Real teams require: (1) Collective work-products, (2) Shifting leadership roles depending on task expertise, and (3) True mutual accountability ('We hold each other accountable').
• **Case: Asian Toys:** Founded in 1911 with an 80-year unblemished safety record. The flagship product 'Play Time' (construction toy with small rubber rivets, selling 35,000 holiday sets) suffered two child choking deaths in 7 months (Ahmedabad and Juhu). Chairman Chamanlal convened his TMT (Finance, Marketing, Manufacturing, PR, Legal).
- *IGP Takeaway:* Product met all TMAI/ISB legal standards, but legal compliance is the floor—not the ceiling—of ethical responsibility.
- *Learning Failure:* First death was treated with *single-loop learning* ('isolated freak accident'); second death forced *double-loop learning* (questioning product design and executing a full recall/redesign).
- *TMT Silos:* Legal urged defense, Finance guarded inventory costs, Marketing protected holiday shipments — proving Katzenbach's working group friction.

PART V: MASTER CASE COMPARISON MATRIX FOR OPEN-BOOK EXAM

Case Name	Core OB Dilemma	Primary Frameworks Applied	Root Cause Analysis	Key Managerial / Structural Intervention
Strike in Space (Skylab 3, 1973)	Astronaut 1-day work stoppage / strike in space.	EVLN Model, Goal Incompatibility, Benchmark Bias, Psych Safety.	42 daily micro-management tasks, unrealistic baseline from Skylab 2, public reprimand over motion sickness.	Carr's 'declaration of independence' sensitivity session; forced Mission Control into collaborative scheduling.
Paul McGinley (Ryder Cup 2014)	Leading 12 individualist Type A1 golfers as a unified team.	Expert Power, Stealth Management, Pull Status, Sub-national Identity.	Golfers are naturally self-absorbed individualists without team-sport habits or collective culture.	Data analytics (`strokeaverage.com`) for par-5 pairings; caddy empowerment; 3-line communication; 5th vice-captain.
Henry Tam (MGI Team, 2002)	Team deadlock 3 weeks before HBS contest deadline.	Belbin Roles, Brett's Multicultural Barriers, Faultlines, Team Chemistry.	Role ambiguity (interns vs CEOs), faultlines (MBAs vs Russian founders), clash over Education vs Entertainment market.	Structural Intervention (pre-planned 'good cop / bad cop' routine), Monitor Evaluator data stacks, task subgrouping.

Case Name	Core OB Dilemma	Primary Frameworks Applied	Root Cause Analysis	Key Managerial / Structural Intervention
Greg James (Sun Microsystems)	HS Holdings server outage escalation failure across global sites.	Lojeski's Virtual Distance, Proximity Bias, Psych Safety, Open Work.	Fixed 08:00 PST calls (15-hr India days), water-cooler bias in Santa Clara, French pay friction, UAE relationship pace.	Error-proof queuing protocols, rotate call schedules, redistribute creative tasks to India, open decision logs.
AXB 1344 (Air India Express)	Fatal plane overrun crash at Calicut airport.	Voice vs Silence, Psych Safety, Power Distance, Edmondson's Anxiety Zone.	Authoritarian captain, stiff hierarchy, co-pilot hedged call-outs without formal agency or safety to intervene.	Establish psychological safety, mandate non-punitive speak-up protocols, train senior leaders in receptiveness.
Asian Toys (1911 Heritage)	Two child choking deaths from flagship 'Play Time' rubber rivets.	Katzenbach's TMT Myth, Single vs Double-Loop Learning, Moral Responsibility.	TMT functional silos (Legal defense vs Finance cost vs Marketing shipments); legal compliance treated as ceiling.	Transition TMT from Working Group to Real Team; execute double-loop learning via full product recall & rivet redesign.
Ramesh & Gargi (Chrysalis L&D;)	Interpersonal conflict & schedule friction in L&D; team.	P-O vs P-G Fit, EVLN Model, Work Style & Role Expectations.	Gargi's erratic timings and refusal to coordinate events vs Ramesh's expectations of team consensus and visibility.	Clarify role boundaries, align work-hour expectations, establish transparent team communication norms.

QUICK-REFERENCE GUIDE

Final Exam Tip: Keep this document directly next to your exam booklet. When reading the exam case scenario, first scan Part V (Master Case Matrix) to identify the closest matching case, then jump to Parts I–IV for exact theoretical terminology and diagnostic definitions.